HMRC / German customs | Verification responses & consultation record

ARCHIVED COPY | FICTIONAL CASE RECORD | References and identities are simulated.

HMRC response to V1 | 2 December 2025

Reply reference	UK-OV-25-918 / linked to DE-OV-25-103
Product population	Calder works orders P-2302-14, P-2302-19, P-2311-06 and P-2311-12
Administrative description	HMRC inspected the exporter's records and facilities and found varying stages of imported wet-end assembly and source documentation; the summary was prepared on the evidence then held by the exporter.

The response encloses an explanation of UK manufacturing routes and notes that the exporter relied on Vale-origin declarations. HMRC was unable to confirm the origin of all units from the four works orders solely on the supplier records provided in this first visit. The request file was not closed as a ruling on every finished unit.

HMRC response to V2 | 17 March 2026

Reply reference	UK-OV-26-141 / linked to DE-OV-26-022
Goods examined	Engineering records and production-order schedules for P-2408-12, P-2408-17, P-2503-18 and P-2503-22
Positive opinion	HMRC records a favourable origin opinion for the finished products linked to P-2408-12 and P-2503-22, on the basis of documents and operations reviewed at Calder.
Further findings	For P-2408-17 and P-2503-18 the submitted value and supplier records did not provide equivalent assurance; HMRC described the evidence and asked for additional review rather than giving a favourable opinion for those works orders.

The accompanying schedules refer to the RheinMotion ESS-430-8 operations, the Calder production routes and a restricted technical-cost annex. HMRC did not transmit that restricted annex in full, relying on the confidentiality mechanism provided in the agreement. The UK note offered a suitably framed technical discussion with German customs.

German intention to deny / HMRC notification | 5 May 2026

From	Hauptzollamt Hamburg to HMRC
Reference	DE-OV-26-022 / notice following UK-OV-26-141
Reasoning advanced	The importing authority considered the value records and material descriptions insufficient to confirm the requested origin position across the entire two-entry file and indicated that it might deny preferential treatment notwithstanding the favourable portions of HMRC's opinion.

The German letter made no separate finding that the restricted technical annex itself contained disqualifying information. It requested consultation and further justification for parts of the affirmative origin assessment.

HMRC consultation request | 8 May 2026

HMRC requested discussions under the TCA procedure concerning the intended denial for the products covered by its favourable opinion. UK officials offered written explanations of product scope and separate clarification of manufacturing-cost inputs.

Bilateral technical meeting | 16 June 2026

Participant note	Recorded position
German customs	A generic supplier statement does not establish origin across successive physical revisions; the verification file should identify which product builds were actually examined.
HMRC	Its affirmative view related to specified works orders, not to every MK-II pump sold by Calder. Supporting reasoning includes the German production file for RM-SW-430 and the UK manufacturing log. HMRC does not consent to disclosure of other customer price data.
Joint minute	No agreement reached on treatment of the products and value inputs outside the favourable HMRC scope. Further technical enquiries remain open; no jointly agreed determination of all lines recorded.

UK follow-up | 25 June 2026

HMRC reiterated its earlier opinion for the expressly identified works orders and supplied a summary of tested production operations. It did not confirm that all pumps on the two import declarations were originating. The German team recorded that it remained dissatisfied with the degree of underlying cost disclosure.